

« Mainmast tabernacle
When the crew of the *Olympias* is required to hoist the galley's masts and sails, the foot of the mainmast is slotted into this solid base.

» View from the stern
The helmsman's position overlooks the central slot between the decks covering the oarsmen, where the mast is stowed when not in use.



« Trierarch's seat
At the stern of the galley beneath the ornamental sternpost sat the trierarch, the man responsible for fitting out and crewing the ship. In front of his chair the handles of the two tillers are visible.



» Central gangway
The narrow gangway that runs the length of the ship also serves as a storage area for the masts and spare spars, oars, ropes, and sails.

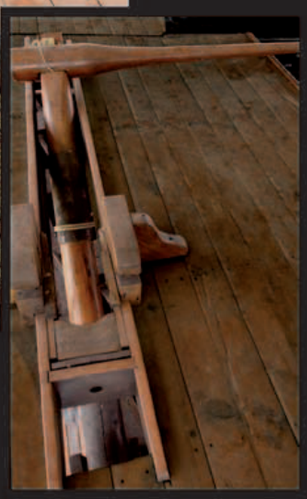


» Tiller
The two tillers can be controlled by a single helmsman, but if extra force is needed, one man can pull on one, while a second man pushes the other.



« Thranites' benches
The topmost tier of oarsmen, the thranites, whose oars passed through the outrigger, were the only ones who could actually see their oars entering the water.

» The oarsman's seats
This view shows the extremely cramped positions occupied by the three tiers of oarsmen: the thranites above, the zygians below them, and the thalamians at the bottom.





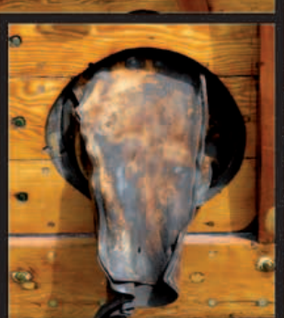
« Oar handles
The inner part of the oar, the loom, is thick and heavy, giving the oarsman greater control when raising the blade from the water and moving it back for the next stroke.





« The three banks of oars
At any point on the *Olympias* the oars are of the same length for each of the three banks of oarsmen. Where the ship narrows, however, at the bow and the stern, slightly shorter oars are used.

» Steering oar
The *Olympias* is fitted with a pair of steering oars (rudders) on either side of the ship. These can be lowered into the water and used as brakes to the ship's foreward movement on one side or the other. They are controlled from a pair of tillers on the quarterdeck.



» Protective sleeve
The lowest bank of oars, that of the thalamian rowers, was much closer to the waterline than the other two. In order to prevent water from splashing through the holes, they were fitted with a protective leather sleeve.





« Foot stretcher
The oarsmen crewing the reconstructed *Olympias* have experimented with various methods of rowing, including this means of securing one foot on the stretcher.